

Appian Interview Experience

(Quality Engineering Intern)

Abhijith.M

About Appian Corporation

Appian Corporation is an American cloud computing and enterprise software company headquartered in McLean, Virginia, part of the Dulles Technology Corridor. The company sells a **Platform as a Service (PaaS)** for building enterprise software applications. It focuses on:

- Low-code development
- Process mining
- Business process management
- Case management markets in North America, Europe, the Middle East, and South-east Asia

Appian offers a low-code platform with a visual interface and pre-built development modules, enabling businesses to create apps and automations using little or no code.

Interview Rounds

The selection process consisted of four stages:

1. Online Assessment
2. Technical Round 1
3. Technical Round 2
4. HR Round

A total of **149 students** appeared for the assessment. After the assessment, **18 students** were shortlisted for the interview process.

1. Online Assessment

Held on the **Glider** platform. This stage consisted of:

- Multiple-choice questions on:
 - Analytical and logical reasoning
 - Software testing fundamentals
 - Basic quality concepts
- One coding question:
 - **Problem:** Remove duplicate strings from a string array.
 - **Languages allowed:** Java and Python.
 - **Note:** The program had to accept *manual input* from the user during execution; there were no predefined inputs or automatic test cases.

2. Technical Round 1

This round included:

- A puzzle: *There are nine coins, one heavier than the other eight. Using a two-pan balance and only two weighings, find the heavier coin.*
- A coding question: Write a program to check whether a given string is a palindrome.
 - Discussed edge cases such as empty strings, whitespace-only strings, and various input formats.
 - Performed a dry run of the code.
- Discussion of my internship in the **CSE Department Internal Automation Project**.
- Discussion of my contributions to the **Web Development Team of the CUIC Portal**.
- Questions on the projects listed in my resume.

3. Technical Round 2 (Techno-cum-Behavioural)

This round combined technical testing knowledge and behavioural questions:

- Questions on different types of testing:
 - Unit testing
 - Integration testing
 - System testing
 - Acceptance testing
 - Regression testing
 - White box testing
 - Black box testing
- Behavioural questions such as:
 - Why Appian?
 - Why do you want the QE role?

4. HR Round

The HR round covered:

- Academic details: marks in 10th, 11th, 12th, CGPA (**8.29 at the time**), and JEE Mains percentile.
- Motivation: why I want the QE role.

After all the rounds, only 3 out of the 18 interviewees were selected — 2 from CEG and 1 from MIT. I am fortunate to be one of the three selected candidates for the role of Quality Engineering Intern.

Key Takeaways

1. Your communication skills matter — express your thoughts clearly.
2. Be genuinely curious to learn. Even if you do not know about something, show eagerness to understand and explore it.
3. Start your preparation early, and know your resume **inside out** — every single point should be explainable.
4. DSA is important for all roles; learning puzzles and aptitude too is important.

5. Maintain a good CGPA **from the first semester itself**; it really does give you an advantage.
If you have a low CGPA, compensate with relevant experience such as internships (even short-term or unpaid), open-source contributions, maintaining club or department websites, or projects in the CSE department. These activities demonstrate teamwork, initiative, and practical exposure.
6. Finally, have hope rather than rigid expectations. Keep the mindset: “*Whatever happens, happens,*” because luck can also be a factor.

Overall Experience

The interview process was an enriching experience that tested my analytical skills, coding abilities, testing knowledge, and communication skills.

Contact

Name: Abhijith.M

Email: abhijithmeleppat@gmail.com

Phone: +91 80788 08266

LinkedIn: [linkedin.com/in/abhijith-m-a3541b278](https://www.linkedin.com/in/abhijith-m-a3541b278)

If you have any doubts, feel free to reach out - happy to help!